

Twelfth Sunday in Ordinary Time

Year A — June 21, 2026

PC-S36-A: U.S. Roman Missal, Third Edition; Lectionary no. 94

Textual unit	Text / citation
Introductory Rites	
Entrance Antiphon	cf. Ps. 28:8–9
Collect	<i>Sancti nominis tui... timorem pariter et amorem</i>
Liturgy of the Word	
First Reading	Jer. 20:10–13
Responsorial Psalm	Ps. 69:8–10, 14, 17, 33–35; response 14c
Second Reading	Rom. 5:12–15
Gospel Acclamation	John 15:26b, 27a
Gospel	Matt. 10:26–33
Liturgy of the Eucharist	
Prayer over Offerings	<i>Suscipe... sacrificium placationis et laudis</i>
Communion Antiphon	A: Ps. 145:15; B: John 10:11, 15
Prayer after Communion	<i>Sacri Corporis et Sanguinis pretiosi alimonia renovati</i>

Sense	Synthesis
Literal	Jeremiah hears hostile whispering yet entrusts his cause to God; Jesus commands disciples to bear witness without servile fear; Paul contrasts Adam's trespass with Christ's overflowing gift.
Allegorical	Christ is the faithful witness; unselected Communion B also names him as the Good Shepherd who gives his life. In him the Church receives the Spirit, confesses publicly, and is fed at one table.
Moral	Courage is truthful fidelity under providence, not emotional invulnerability or reckless exposure. Holy fear and love displace servile terror while preserving prudence and justice.
Anagogical	What is concealed will be disclosed; God remembers the whole person, raises hope beyond bodily death, and brings Christ's superabundant gift toward final redemption.

In Illo Tempore...

Canonical order governs; composition and narrated events are distinguished, while inherited attributions and modern historical judgments remain visibly separate.

Textual unit / alternative	Citation	Location	Date
Entrance	Ps. 28:8–9	Israel; exact composition place unknown	Traditional Davidic attribution; historical date uncertain
The inherited title names David. The psalm moves from divine majesty to the Lord as strength of his people and shepherd of his inheritance. The Entrance uses the pastoral conclusion; neither authorship site nor date can be recovered securely.			
Responsorial Psalm	Ps. 69:8–10, 14, 17, 33–35	Israel; Jerusalem imagery, precise writing site unknown	Traditional Davidic attribution; historical date uncertain
The title places the lament in Davidic tradition. Reproach, zeal, petition, and praise of the poor coexist. The appointed verses omit much of the psalm's imprecatory and autobiographical texture; the wider lament remains relevant context but is not silently inserted into the proclamation.			
Comm. A	Ps. 145:15	Israel's worship; exact place unknown	Davidic title; historical date uncertain
This acrostic praise psalm confesses God's kingship, compassion, justice, and provision for creatures. Communion alternative A uses the image of eyes turned to God for food.			
First Reading	Jer. 20:10–13	Judah / Jerusalem; final book shaped through later transmission	Prophetic event late seventh or early sixth century BC
The book identifies Jeremiah's long ministry across Judah's final decades. Chapter 20 follows Pashhur's beating and confinement of the prophet. The appointed confidence is surrounded by complaint and later curse; preserving that context prevents courage from being reduced to uninterrupted emotional calm.			
Gospel	Matt. 10:26–33	Canonical Gospel: traditional Palestine; modern Antioch proposal uncertain	Traditionally early apostolic period; modern majority c. AD 80–90
Narrated event	Matt. 4:23; 10:1–33	Galilee; exact speaking site unrecorded	Public ministry, c. AD 28–29
Ancient tradition identifies the Apostle Matthew writing for Jewish believers. The canonical Greek Gospel is commonly dated after AD 70. The narrated sayings stand inside the missionary discourse: persecution is already named before Jesus repeats the command not to fear.			
Comm. B	John 10:11, 15	Canonical Gospel: traditional Ephesus; modern history debated	Late first century
Narrated event	John 9:1–10:21	Jerusalem ministry	c. AD 29
The Good Shepherd discourse contrasts Jesus' self-gift with abandonment by a hireling. Communion alternative B identifies reception with the shepherd who knows the sheep and lays down his life.			
Acclamation	John 15:26b, 27a	Canonical Gospel: traditional Ephesus; modern history debated	Late first century
Narrated event	John 13:1; 15:18–27	Jerusalem, final supper	c. AD 29–30
The acclamation draws from Jesus' promise amid the world's hatred: the Spirit bears witness and the disciples also testify. Liturgically it welcomes the Gospel's demand for public acknowledgment.			
Second Reading	Rom. 5:12–15	Corinth, Achaia (present-day Greece), to churches at Rome	c. AD 56–58
Paul writes to mixed Jewish and Gentile churches at Rome. The appointed boundary begins the Adam–Christ comparison and stops before its later elaboration. The gift is expressly “not like” the trespass: grace exceeds, rather than merely balances, sin's devastation.			

The Propers: Themes and Movement

Governing account: witness under providence, grace beyond trespass

Jeremiah and Matthew form the Lectionary's official witness-under-persecution relation; Psalm 69 answers it in lament and praise, and John 15 acclaims the Spirit's testimony. Romans proceeds independently from Adam's trespass to Christ's greater gift, while the Missal surrounds both strands with holy fear and love, reconciliation and praise, shepherding nourishment, and promised renewal.

Affliction named → fear reordered → witness confessed → life received

1. Affliction is spoken before courage (*Jeremiah, Psalm*)

Jeremiah's confidence comes from within hostility, not above it. Psalm 69 likewise preserves reproach, petition, zeal, and praise of the poor. Their liturgical relation refuses two reductions: suffering is neither proof of abandonment nor an emotion to suppress. Trust can ask for deliverance while naming danger truthfully.

2. Fear is reordered by knowledge and love (*Collect, Gospel*)

The Collect holds fear and love together around God's holy name. Matthew distinguishes fear of persecutors from reverence for the One who judges and preserves the whole person. Chrysostom reads sparrows and numbered hairs as assurance of exhaustive divine knowledge, while denying that every creaturely fall is positively caused by God.

3. Witness belongs to Spirit and disciple (*Acclamation, Gospel, Romans*)

John's acclamation gives priority to the Spirit's testimony and then names the disciples' witness. Jesus requires public acknowledgment without promising immunity. Romans independently declares a still deeper disproportion: humanity's solidarity in Adam is answered not by an equal counterweight but by Christ's abundant gift. Courage is therefore graced fidelity, not personality or bravado.

4. The Shepherd feeds toward redemption (*Entrance, Prayer over Offerings, Communion, Prayer after Communion*)

The Entrance and Communion option B supply shepherd language; option A names creaturely dependence for food. The offering prayer joins reconciliation and praise, while the concluding prayer names renewal by Christ's Body and Blood. These shared Week XII texts can frame fearless witness sacramentally, but their use across A/B/C prevents a claim that they were composed for Matthew 10.

Pastoral control

"Do not be afraid" never commands concealment of abuse, refusal of lawful protection, medical neglect, or reckless self-exposure. Providence includes creaturely causes and prudent action. Christian witness may be costly, but suffering is not sought as an end and perpetrators are not excused as instruments of God.

Theological and Spiritual Synthesis

These texts present courage as graced witness rather than emotional invulnerability. Jeremiah speaks trust from within affliction; Christ orders fear through divine judgment and providential care; the acclamation gives priority to the Spirit's testimony before the disciple's confession. Romans places every act of witness beneath Christ's gift, whose abundance exceeds Adam's trespass.

Holy fear and love therefore sustain truthful fidelity together with prudence and justice. The Entrance and the two Communion antiphons name strength, provision, and the Good Shepherd's self-gift, while the offering and post-Communion prayers move through reconciliation, praise, nourishment, and renewal. Their horizon is the disclosure of truth, care for the whole person, and final redemption in Christ.

Dimension	Appointed anchors	Source-grounded synthesis	Limit
Christological	Matt. 10:26–33; Rom. 5:12–15; Communion B	Christ is the faithful witness and Good Shepherd whose self-gift exceeds Adam's trespass and grounds the disciple's public confession.	Romans remains a semi-continuous strand, and the Good Shepherd antiphon is an unselected alternative rather than a text enacted in every Mass.
Providential	Jer. 20:10–13; Ps. 69; Gospel	The threatened prophet, afflicted psalmist, and commissioned disciples entrust truth and the whole person to God's exhaustive knowledge and judgment.	Providence does not mean that God positively causes abuse, persecution, or every creaturely fall; lament, protection, and prudent action remain legitimate.
Ecclesial and sacramental	John 15:26b, 27a; Prayer over Offerings; Prayer after Communion	The Spirit's testimony precedes ecclesial witness, while reconciliation, praise, nourishment by Christ's Body and Blood, and renewal order confession within received worship.	The acclamation welcomes the Gospel rather than becoming another reading; the Week XII orations serve A/B/C and do not prove one compositional design.
Moral and eschatological	Collect; Jeremiah; Gospel; Romans; Prayer after Communion	Holy fear and love sustain truthful fidelity without servile terror, under the promise that truth will be disclosed and Christ's greater gift tends toward final redemption.	Courage is not emotional invulnerability, reckless exposure, concealment of abuse, or contempt for bodily life and lawful protection.

The Propers: Detailed Commentary

Strength, shepherding, and holy fear (*Entrance, Collect*)

The Entrance adapts Psalm 28's closing confession: the majestic Lord is also strength, refuge, savior, and shepherd. The image protects courage from self-reliance. The people facing witness are an inheritance carried by another, not a heroic elite sustained by temperament.

The Collect's paired fear and love rejects both servile terror and sentimental familiarity. Reverence recognizes God's holiness and judgment; love cleaves to his name and trusts his governance.

Jeremiah's lament and Matthew's disclosure (*First Reading, Psalm, Gospel*)

Jeremiah hears denunciation from every side, even from those watching for his fall. Yet he submits his cause to the One who tests the just and sees inward truth. The reading ends in praise, but the surrounding chapter proceeds into curse and anguish. Scripture therefore permits the persecuted believer to confess trust without pretending that trauma produces simple emotional serenity.

Psalm 69 answers in the first person. Reproach touches the servant because of zeal for God's house; the petition seeks an answer in divine kindness; the poor are finally summoned to praise. Augustine's ecclesial and Christological reception hears the suffering Christ and his body in the psalm, but it does not erase the lament's Israelite voice or prove the later Lectionary pairing's history.

Matthew's repeated prohibition of fear is reasoned. What is concealed will be disclosed; disciples cannot finally secure truth through silence. Human persecutors possess limited power. God knows creatures down to sparrows and hairs, and Christ will acknowledge those who acknowledge him. These claims establish divine judgment and care, not present immunity.

Chrysostom's distinction is precise: nothing falls outside God's knowledge and providential ordering, yet the text does not require saying that God positively effects every sparrow's fall. Catholic doctrine likewise distinguishes divine first causality, creaturely causes, permission of evil, and God's ability to bring good without making evil good. That distinction is decisive whenever this Gospel is preached to vulnerable persons.

The Spirit's testimony and the disciple's speech (*Acclamation*)

John 15 places witness amid hatred and expulsion. The Spirit of truth testifies to Christ; disciples also testify because they have been with him. The acclamation therefore protects Matthew 10 from individualism. Public confession is ecclesial and pneumatological before it is a test of private nerve. The verse welcomes Christ's Gospel word; it is not another semi-continuous reading.

The gift is not like the trespass (*Second Reading*)

Romans 5:12–15 begins a dense comparison whose grammar continues beyond the appointed boundary. Paul traces sin and death through Adam and then interrupts any expectation of equal symmetry: Christ's gracious gift is not like the trespass. Chrysostom emphasizes this excess. One act's devastation becomes the occasion for displaying a gift whose abundance cannot be represented as a mere zero-sum cancellation.

This apostolic strand remains semi-continuous. It should not be forced into an allegory in which Adam equals persecutor or Christ equals Jeremiah. Its liturgical contribution is plural: the same assembly hearing the demand for witness also hears that salvation originates in a gift exceeding inherited ruin.

Reconciliation, praise, and nourishment (*Prayer over Offerings, Communion, Prayer after Communion*)

The Prayer over the Offerings identifies the sacrificial movement as reconciliation and praise while asking that those offering be purified. Worship is therefore not a bribe paid by the endangered, nor a reward for courage; it is God's reconciling gift received and returned in praise.

Communion option A places every creature before the giver of food. Option B names the Good Shepherd whose self-gift distinguishes him from the hireling who abandons the flock. The Prayer after Communion then asks renewal through the precious Body and Blood toward redemption. The alternatives thus emphasize either creaturely dependence or the Shepherd's sacrificial care while converging in Christ's nourishing gift.

The Propers: Interpretive Possibilities

Editorial status

The following are original editorial or AI-generated possibilities. They are attributed to none of the cited authorities and claim no historical compositional intent. Each states its anchors and limits.

Witness as received speech. (*Acclamation, Gospel*) The Spirit's testimony in the acclamation and Christ's demand for acknowledgment may support formation in which courage begins by receiving truthful speech before speaking it. This does not eliminate preparation, prudence, or the distinct authority of ordained and lay witness.

Providence and safeguarding as allies. (*Entrance, Gospel*) God's knowledge of the sparrow and the Entrance's shepherd image may encourage communities to make vulnerable lives visible through reporting, protection, and material care. The analogy is pastoral, not compositional; it cannot reduce providence to policy or policy to faith.

A gift greater than inherited fear. (*Romans, Gospel*) Romans' unequal Adam–Christ comparison can illuminate how patterns of fear transmitted through families or institutions are real yet not ultimate. The limit is strict: Paul addresses sin and grace, not a modern clinical theory, and spiritual language never substitutes for trauma-informed care.

Appendix: Liturgical Resolution

Liturgical Instance

Field	Resolved liturgical instance
Formula and occurrence	PC-S36-A; Sunday Mass for the Twelfth Sunday in Ordinary Time; 21 June 2026; green.
Books and territory	<i>Roman Missal, Third Edition</i> , English for the United States (implemented 2011), and U.S. <i>Lectionary for Mass</i> , Second Typical Edition, Volume I, no. 94.
Calendar and cycle	U.S. implementation of the General Roman Calendar; Sunday Year A.
Formulary and textual scope	Ordinary Time Week XII. Its shared audit owns the Missal formulary; this leaf owns the dated Year A composition and its two Communion-antiphon alternatives.

Branch Resolution

Branch ID	Authority and trigger	Status	Units affected	Resolution
communion-antiphon-psalm-145	Week XII formulary	Appointed alternative	Psalms 145 option	Documented, not selected
communion-antiphon-john-10	Week XII formulary	Appointed alternative	John 10 option	Documented, not selected

References

- USCCB, Twelfth Sunday in Ordinary Time, 21 June 2026, U.S. Lectionary 94; and 2026 Liturgical Calendar, accessed 2026-07-15.
- *Missale Romanum*, editio typica tertia (2002), pp. 462–463; reimpressio emendata (2008); and *Roman Missal, Third Edition*, U.S. English edition implemented 2011.
- Bishops’ Conference of England and Wales, *Antiphonary: Excerpted from the Roman Missal* (ICEL, 2010), pp. 72–73, used as official corroboration of the common ICEL antiphons, not as a substitute U.S. altar book.
- *General Instruction of the Roman Missal* 46–90; *General Introduction to the Lectionary* 65–69, 78–91, 93–110.
- St. John Chrysostom, *Homily 34 on Matthew* and *Homily 10 on Romans*.
- St. Augustine, *Exposition on Psalm 69*.
- *Catechism of the Catholic Church* 302–314 and 402–412; Council of Trent, Session V.

Search Scope and Limitations

Instance: instance/manifest.md. **Leaf composition audit:** propers/verified.md. **Canonical formulary owner:** ../shared/ordinary-time/weeks/12/propers/verified.md. **Research audit:** research/scope.md. **Coverage:** the complete formula and branches, official dated Lectionary path, immediate biblical contexts, direct Chrysostom reception of Matthew and Romans, Augustine on Psalm 69, and doctrinal illumination were studied. **Limits:** no exhaustive manuscript, untranslated-corpus, subscription-database, or proper-calendar survey is claimed. Complete U.S. English altar-book oration collation and independent theological review remain outstanding.

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